QIUHAO (BRAD) ZHAO



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Research Interests

Urban environment and mental health · Urban sustainability and social equity · Tourism big data analysis
Spatiotemporal machine learning · Multimodal big data & large language models · Geographic information science

Education

Ph.D. in Resources, Environment & Regional Planning Sep. 2022 – Jul. 2027 (expected)
School of Earth Sciences, Zhejiang University (ZJU)
(U.S. News 2026–2027 #35 globally/#3 in Mainland China | QS 2027 #47 globally/#5 in Mainland China | Project 985)
Advisor: Prof. Pingbin Jin | National Scholarship recipient (2025)
Thesis draft completed: *Evaluation of Tourism Destination Competitiveness and the Spatiotemporal Heterogeneity of Its Determinants*

B.S. in Human Geography & Urban-Rural Planning Sep. 2018 – Jun. 2022
School of Earth Sciences, Zhejiang University (ZJU)
(U.S. News 2026–2027 #35 globally/#3 in Mainland China | QS 2027 #47 globally/#5 in Mainland China | Project 985)
GPA: 3.83/4.0 | GPA rank: Top 3 in the programme | Outstanding Graduate, Zhejiang University (2022)

Selected Publications

Published — First Author

Journal Metrics: 2025

[1] **Zhao, Q.**, Li, H.*, Wang, B., Xu, P., & Jin, P.* (2026). Unveiling dynamic determinants of tourism competitiveness: Analysis integrating multimodal data and spatiotemporal machine learning. *Journal of Travel Research*, 65(6), 1871–1894. DOI: 10.1177/00472875251349239.
(**Top-three journal in tourism; ABDC A*, ABS 4, SSCI JCR Q1, IF = 9.7, IF-5 = 11.0; CAS Zone 1 Top**)

[2] **Zhao, Q.**, Xu, P., Wang, B., Wu, S., Wu, M., & Jin, P.* (2024). Does location affect the mechanism of tourism competitiveness? Evidence from machine learning analysis. *Tourism Management Perspectives*, 53, 101291. DOI: 10.1016/j.tmp.2024.101291.
(**ABDC A*, SSCI JCR Q1, IF = 8.3, IF-5 = 9.1; CAS Zone 2 Top**)

[3] **Zhao, Q.**, Jin, P., Wang, B., & Xu, P.* (2023). Evaluation of rural tourism competitiveness based on multi-source data and machine learning: A case study of Lin'an District in Hangzhou, China. *Progress in Geography*, 42(8), 1541–1555. DOI: 10.18306/dlkxjz.2023.08.008. (**CAST T1, CSSCI, CSCD, CNKI Composite IF = 7.2**)

Under Revision — First Author

[4] **Zhao, Q.**, Wang, C. C., Yang, L., Xu, P., Chai, S., Wang, M.*, & Jin, P.* Social inequalities in access to sustainable dining in Hong Kong: A multimodal, LLM-based analysis of dining conditions, walking access and planning priorities. *Under revision.*

Under Review — First Author

[5] **Zhao, Q.**, Xu, P., & Jin, P.* Seen or felt? How objective and perceived streetscape cues shape home-sharing performance. *Under review.*

Working Papers — First Author

[6] **Zhao, Q.**, Wang, J., Wang, M., Yang, J., Chai, S., Xu, P., Wang, C. C., Wu, S.*, & Jin, P.* Urban environmental perception gaps are linked to unequal mental health burdens. *Working paper.*

[7] **Zhao, Q.**, Jin, P., & Xu, P.* Predicting urban carbon emissions using multimodal big data and spatiotemporal machine learning. *Working paper.*

[8] **Zhao, Q.**, Jin, P., & Wang, C. C.* Urban environmental effects on employee mental health: Evidence from multimodal data and spatiotemporal machine-learning regression. *Working paper.*

Working Paper — Corresponding Author

[9] Xu, P., Yan, S., Li, J., Jin, P., & **Zhao, Q.*** Settlement visibility across planning scales: Survey and UAV evidence for rural landscape assessment. *Working paper.*

Selected Co-authored Publications

[10] Li, X., Dogru, T., **Zhao, Q.**, Liang, C., & Li, H. (2026). Tourism development in the context of ecological transformation: The role of governments' environmental protection attention. *Journal of Sustainable Tourism*. DOI: 10.1080/09669582.2026.2696427. (ABS 3, SSCI JCR Q1, IF = 8.4, IF-5 = 10.6)

[11] Xu, P., Zhou, G., **Zhao, Q.**, Lu, Y., & Chen, J. (2024). Spatial-temporal dynamics and influencing factors of city-level carbon emission of mainland China. *Ecological Indicators*, 167, 112672. DOI: 10.1016/j.ecolind.2024.112672. (SCI JCR Q1, IF = 8.7, IF-5 = 8.5)

[12] Wang, B., **Zhao, Q.**, Zhang, Z., Xu, P., Tian, X., & Jin, P. (2025). Understanding the heterogeneity and dynamics of factors influencing tourist sentiment with online reviews. *Journal of Theoretical and Applied Electronic Commerce Research*, 20(1), 22. DOI: 10.3390/jtaer20010022. (SSCI JCR Q2, IF = 4.5, IF-5 = 5.1)

[13] Zou, Y., **Zhao, Q.**, Wang, B., & Chen, G. (2025). Sentiment mining of online comments of sports venues: Consumer satisfaction and its influencing factors. *PLOS ONE*, 20(5), e0319476. DOI: 10.1371/journal.pone.0319476. (SCI JCR Q2, IF = 2.8, IF-5 = 3.3)

[14] Qi, D., Wang, B., **Zhao, Q.**, & Jin, P. (2024). Research on the spatial network structure of tourist flows in Hangzhou based on BERT-BiLSTM-CRF. *ISPRS International Journal of Geo-Information*, 13(4), 139. DOI: 10.3390/ijgi13040139. (SCI JCR Q2, IF = 3.2, IF-5 = 3.5)

Conference Presentations

IPAS 2025 — The University of Tokyo, Japan (Poster) Nov. 2025
APacCHRIE 2025 — Chiang Mai University, Thailand (Oral) May 2025
IMPACT 2024 — The Hong Kong Polytechnic University (Oral) Oct. 2024
National Tourism Geography Annual Conference — Guangzhou, China (Oral) Jul. 2024
National Human Geography Conference — Northwest Normal University, Lanzhou, China (Oral) Jul. 2023
Zhejiang Geographical Society Annual Conference — Zhejiang University (Oral) Nov. 2022

Academic Service

Peer Reviewer Metrics: 2025

Annals of Tourism Research (Top-three journal in tourism; SSCI JCR Q1, IF = 8.1, IF-5 = 11.2, ABS 4) 2 reviews
Tourism Management (Top-three journal in tourism; SSCI JCR Q1, IF = 14.5, IF-5 = 14.9, ABDC A*, ABS 4) 2 reviews
International Journal of Hospitality Management (Top-two journal in hospitality; SSCI JCR Q1, IF-5 = 9.9, ABS 3) 2 reviews
Ecological Indicators (SCI JCR Q1, IF = 8.7, IF-5 = 8.5) 1 review
Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services (SSCI JCR Q1, IF = 13.7, IF-5 = 13.5, ABS 2) 3 reviews
Tourism Management Perspectives (SSCI JCR Q1, IF = 8.3, IF-5 = 9.1, ABDC A*) 1 review
Scientific Reports (SCI JCR Q1, IF = 4.9, IF-5 = 4.8) 2 reviews
Current Issues in Tourism (SSCI JCR Q1, IF = 5.0, IF-5 = 6.0, ABDC A) 1 review
npj Heritage Science (Nature Portfolio; SJR = 0.842, SNIP = 1.895) 1 review
Applied Spatial Analysis and Policy (SSCI, IF = 3.1, IF-5 = 2.9) 1 review

Awards & Honors

National Scholarship for PhD Students, Zhejiang University 2025
Outstanding Doctoral Dissertation Support Grant, Zhejiang University 2025
Qiushi Rising Star PhD Fellowship, Zhejiang University 2025
Hong Kong PhD Fellowship Scheme (HKPFS), Research Grants Council 2024
Guo Xie Birong Scholarship, Zhejiang University 2023
Excellent Paper Award for Young Scholars, Geographical Society of Zhejiang Province 2022
Outstanding Graduate, Zhejiang University 2022
Second Prize, 11th National Red Tourism Planning Competition (East China) 2021
Five-Star Volunteer, Zhejiang University 2021
Outstanding Individual in Summer Social Practice, Zhejiang University 2020
Third-Class Academic Scholarship, Zhejiang University 2020, 2021
Outstanding Student, Zhejiang University 2019, 2021

Selected Professional Experience

Project Researcher — Hangzhou Zheda Scenic Tourism Planning & Design Co. Aug. 2020 – Present
Contributed to five tourism-planning projects and led implementation for the Hangzhou Tourism Resources Census (2021–2023), surveying and documenting 1,025 sites across three districts.

Leadership & Activities

Presidium Member — Graduate Student Union, School of Earth Sciences, ZJU Sep. 2022 – Sep. 2023
Managed publicity and communications and co-organised 20+ academic seminars and events.

Group Leader — Summer Social Practice Programme, ZJU Jun. 2020 – Sep. 2020
Led 300+ ZJU student volunteers in delivering online teaching for rural students in Lin'an, Hangzhou.

Selected Personal Projects

KUN Chat — Persona-Grounded Voice AI Live Demo | GitHub
Built a persona-grounded conversational AI system using DeepSeek, MiniMax high-fidelity speech synthesis, persona-specific RAG, and Cloudflare D1; supports fact/style retrieval, voice input, multimodal dialogue, audio caching, and web deployment.

Hao Quant — AI-Assisted Equity Research & Paper-Trading Platform Live Demo | GitHub
Built a Python platform for U.S. and Chinese equities using Futu OpenD, yfinance, and akshare; implements 12-factor ranking, regime/sentiment analysis, ATR controls, backtesting, paper trading, DeepSeek explanations, and optional Futu OpenAPI automation.

Skills & Interests

Programming & GIS: Python (scikit-learn, PyTorch, TensorFlow, GeoPandas), Stata, ArcGIS, QGIS, LaTeX, Codex, Claude Code
Methods: Machine learning, spatiotemporal modelling, multimodal data analysis, LLM applications
Languages: Chinese (native) | English (IELTS 7.0, CET-6 569) **Interests:** Fitness | Basketball | Boxing | Cooking | Baking
Working style: Self-motivated, collaborative, and comfortable working independently.